

Google Business Profile Optimization Guide

Local Map Pack Playbook

The map pack captures the highest-intent local searches. A fully completed, actively maintained profile beats most competitors' entire websites for those queries.

What's inside

- Category selection strategy
- Review velocity and response templates
- Photo cadence and geotagging
- Q&A seeding methodology
- Local citation consistency audit

Profile Foundations

- 01 Choose the most specific primary category available
- 02 Add every relevant secondary category, no padding
- 03 Complete every field — completeness is a ranking input
- 04 Match name, address, and phone exactly across the web

Reviews

- 01 Ask every satisfied customer within 48 hours of service
- 02 Respond to all reviews within one week, positive included
- 03 Never incentivise reviews — it violates policy
- 04 Aim for steady velocity over occasional bursts

Content Signals

- 01 Upload new photos at least monthly
- 02 Post updates weekly with a clear call to action
- 03 Seed and answer common customer questions in Q&A
- 04 Keep hours accurate, especially around holidays

Citations

- 01 Audit top directories for name and address mismatches
- 02 Fix duplicates and claim unmanaged listings
- 03 Prioritise industry-specific directories over volume
- 04 Recheck consistency every six months

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